

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250283924

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

Contreras Guerra; Narciso Alberto et al.

APPARATUS, SYSTEM AND METHOD OF PROVIDING A SMART POWERLINE EVENT AND HEALTH MONITORING OF POWER DISTRIBUTION SYSTEMS USING SURGE PROTECTION DEVICES

Abstract

A smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) structured to be disposed in a power distribution system for a building structure located in a utility system is provided. The SEHM includes: a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; a surge protection device (SPD) connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module structured to transmit the data to the cloud in a wireless connection.

Inventors: Contreras Guerra; Narciso Alberto (Santo Domingo, DO), Herrera Ortiz; Ruben Gamaliel (Santo Domingo Este, DO)

Applicant: EATON INTELLIGENT POWER LIMITED (DUBLIN 4, IE)

Family ID: 1000007738590

Assignee: EATON INTELLIGENT POWER LIMITED (DUBLIN 4, IE)

Appl. No.: 18/599379

Filed: March 08, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G01R19/25 (20060101); G01R31/08 (20200101); H02H7/26 (20060101)

Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The disclosed concept relates generally to an apparatus, system and method of providing a powerline event and health monitoring of power distribution systems using surge protection devices with remote status communicating capability.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0002] Surge protection devices (SPDs) are commonly used to protect electrical and electronic equipment from damage caused by high energy lightning surges and other transient disturbances. These devices include overcurrent protection components such as fuses and temperature coefficient devices (PTCs) or overvoltage protection components such as gas discharge tubes (GDTs), transient voltage suppression (TVS) diodes and metal oxide varistor (MOVs). A GDT may be a ceramic tube sandwiched between metal electrodes and sealed with a rare gas and divert overvoltage to a lower and safer level when an external surge exceeds operating voltage by dissipating plasma gas containing voltage transients. A TVS diode is a clamp device that suppresses all overvoltages above its breakdown voltage by splitting an excess current when the induced voltage exceeds the avalanche breakdown potential. A varistor has a resistance that changes as a function of the voltage that is experienced. At or below a predetermined voltage, the resistance of the varistor is very high. However, the resistance of the varistor drops rapidly in response to voltage above a predetermined threshold. As such, varistors are typically connected between a line conductor and a ground or a neutral conductor and conduct very little current to the ground or neutral conductor when normal voltages, i.e., voltages within a predetermined voltage range, are experienced. However, when the voltage surges outside the predetermined range, the varistors experience reduced resistance and thus shunt electrical power from the voltage surge to the ground or neutral conductor, thereby protecting from destruction a piece of electrical equipment that is connected with the same circuit. One common type of varistor is the metal-oxide varistor (MOV).

[0003] An SPD may include circuitry to detect when a surge protection device (e.g., without limitation, MOVs) has failed and is incapable of providing protection. However, currently available SPDs have limited status communicating capabilities due to their dependence on a visual indicator that requires to be inspected by a user to verify their protection status. For example, they operate with an LED that is turned ON, indicating that the SPD is protecting associated circuits and devices and becomes turned OFF at the moment the surge protection is no longer available (e.g., without limitation, damaged MOVs). As such, in order to determine the status of a conventional SPD, the user is required to visit the circuit panel board or load center and physically inspect the status of the LED to review the SPD's status. Such requirement for physical inspection on site for the status of the SPD is not only inconvenient, but also could lead to catastrophic results if the damaged or non-functioning MOVs are not detected in time.

[0004] There is room for improvement in surge protection devices in power distribution systems.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] These needs, and others, are met by embodiments of the disclosed concept in which a smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) structured to be disposed in a power distribution system for a building structure located in a utility system. The SEHM includes: a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; a surge protection device (SPD) connected to the line conductors and the

neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module being communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module being structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud in a wireless connection.

[0006] Another embodiment provides a utility system including a power source having powerlines; a plurality of building structures each including respective power distribution systems having a smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) electrically connected to the powerlines and structured to monitor powerline event and health based at least in part on changes in line voltages and frequencies and/or a status of a surge protection device (SPD); a mobile user device including an energy monitoring application installed therein; and a power management service cloud communicatively coupled to the communication module of the SEHM and the mobile user device via a wireless connection. The SEHM includes a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in the line voltages and frequencies, an SPD connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor, a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device, and a communication module connected to the controller. The communication module is structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud in a wireless connection.

[0007] In yet another embodiment is provided a method of providing smart powerline event and health monitoring in a utility system having a power distribution system associated with respective building structure. The method includes providing a smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) within a power distribution system, the SEHM including a voltage measurement device electrically connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies, a surge protection device (SPD) having a SPD status indicator, a controller coupled to the voltage measurement device, the SPD and a communication module and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device and transmit data including the measured changes to a cloud communicatively coupled to the communication module, the cloud being structured to receive the data, analyze the measured changes based at least in part on historical data, determine that a powerline event or anomaly has occurred or is about to occur, and transmit a notification to a mobile user device via a wireless connection in response to the determination, the notification including the data, a recommended action and automatic actions that have taken place in response to the determination. The method further includes measuring, by the voltage measurement device, real time changes in line voltages and frequencies and transmitting the measured changes to the controller; receiving and transmitting, by the controller, the measured changes to the cloud; analyzing, by the cloud, the data based at least in part on the historical data; determining, by the cloud, if a powerline event or anomaly has occurred or is about to occur; transmitting, by the cloud, a notification to the mobile user device via the wireless connection; and performing a preventive or remedial action based on the recommended action.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0008] A full understanding of the invention can be gained from the following description of the preferred embodiments when read in conjunction with the accompanying drawings in which:

[0009] FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system logic including a utility system including a plurality

power distribution systems having exemplary smart powerline event and health monitoring device in accordance with a non-limiting, example embodiment of the disclosed concept;

[0010] FIG. 2 is a diagram of a utility system including a plurality power distribution systems having exemplary smart powerline event and health monitoring device in accordance with a non-limiting, example embodiment of the disclosed concept;

[0011] FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a power distribution system including an exemplary smart powerline event and health monitoring device in accordance with an example embodiment of the disclosed concept;

[0012] FIG. 4 is a block diagram of an exemplary smart powerline event and health monitoring device in accordance with the disclosed concept

[0013] FIG. 5 is a block diagram of an exemplary surge protection device in accordance with the disclosed concept;

[0014] FIG. 6 is a flow chart of a method of smart powerline event and health monitoring in a power distribution system accordance with a non-limiting, example embodiment of the disclosed concept; and

[0015] FIG. 7 is a flow chart for a method of smart powerline event and health monitoring in a power distribution system included in a geographical area having a common power source in accordance with the disclosed concept.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0016] Directional phrases used herein, such as, for example, left, right, front, back, top, bottom and derivatives thereof, relate to the orientation of the elements shown in the drawings and are not limiting upon the claims unless expressly recited therein.

[0017] As employed herein, the statement that two or more parts are “coupled” together shall mean that the parts are joined together either directly or joined through one or more intermediate parts.

[0018] FIGS. 1-5 illustrate an exemplary smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) **100** in a power distribution system **30a-n** in accordance with an example embodiment of the disclosed concept. FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system logic including a utility system **1000** and FIG. 2 is a more detailed diagram of a utility system **2000** including a plurality of building structures **20a-n** disposed in a same geographical area **15**. The utility system **1000,2000** includes a utility provider **10**, building structures **20a-n**, power distribution systems **30a-n**, a power management service cloud **40**, and an energy monitoring application **51**. The utility provider **10** is communicatively coupled to the cloud **40**, and optionally, a certified contractor network **53**. The utility provider **10** provides power to the building structures **20a-n** via a local power source **11** (e.g., without limitation, a transformer) in a geographical area **15** (e.g., without limitation, a neighborhood) and monitors the status of the power source **11**. A building structure **20a-n** may be any building structure, e.g., without limitation, a residential housing, offices, schools, hospitals, etc.) and includes a power distribution system **30a-n**. The power distribution system **30a-n** may be, e.g., a load center, a power control center, etc. and connected to the local power source **11** via the powerlines **12**. It is also communicatively connected to the power management service cloud **40**. The power distribution system **30a-n** is described further with reference to FIG. 3.

[0019] The power management service cloud **40** may be communicatively coupled to or include a database **42** structured to store, e.g., without limitation, customer data including, e.g., without limitation, measured changes in line voltages and frequencies, powerline event or anomaly data, power usage data and historical data associated with a particular customer of a power management service provider. The power management service cloud **40** is also communicatively coupled to the utility provider **10**, the SEHM **100** and an energy monitoring application **51**. The energy monitoring application **51** may be installed in a mobile user device (e.g., without limitation, smart phones, smart tablet, or other mobile smart devices) **50a-n**. The SEHM **100** transmits data including, e.g., without limitation, the measured changes in line voltage and frequencies, device IDs, user information or geolocation information to the power management service cloud **40**. Upon

receiving the data, the power management service cloud **40** analyzes the data based at least in part on historical data including past powerline events, powerline related anomalies or activity logs stored in the database **42**. The cloud **40** updates the database **42** based on the data and analysis results. The data analysis or determination of powerline events or anomalies may trigger automatic and/or manual actions. Automatic actions include, e.g., without limitation, termination of power supply to critical or sensitive equipment in a building structure **20a-n** by controlling a smart circuit interrupter or devices remotely connected thereto by the user via the energy monitoring application **51**. Further, the power management service cloud **40** may automatically transmit a notice to the utility provider **10** of geographical power events. For example, if a plurality of SEHMs **100** in a same geolocation **15** are transmitting data including similar events, the data may suggest a faulty transformer. Upon receiving a user approval, the utility provider **10** may dispatch a field technician **54** to inspect and diagnose the transformer **11** based on the notice. The utility provider **10** may transmit the automatic actions taken to the cloud **40**. Manual actions may be performed by the user based on the notification. The user may review the notification, inspect the data, view real time status of powerlines **12**, and review historic performance and events of corresponding, e.g., without limitation, power distribution system **30a-n** via the energy monitoring application **51**. The notification may include status of attached surge protection device (SPD) **130**, recommended actions (e.g., without limitation, replacement of the SPD) and the automatic actions taken by the cloud **40** or SEHM **100** based on the data. Based on the notification, the user may reach out to a field technician (e.g., a field personnel **44** in FIG. 2) who can turn off the power to critical or sensitive equipment, determine if an SPD **130** within the SEHM **100** needs to be replaced and/or perform appropriate maintenance or repairs. Optionally, the user may contact the certified contractor network **53** and request support.

[0020] FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a power distribution system **30** including an exemplary smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) **100** in accordance with an example embodiment of the disclosed concept. A power distribution system **30** includes LINE conductors **14**, a NEUTRAL conductor **16** and a ground (not shown) and is structured to distribute power to associated loads via the LINE conductors **14**. It is connected to the power source **11** at the LINE conductors **14** and distributes power from the utility provider **10**. It also includes a main circuit interrupter **32**, a plurality of branch circuit interrupters **34** that are connected to respective loads and the SEHM **100**. The main circuit interrupter **32** is connected to the LINE conductors **14** and feeds power to the branch circuit interrupters **34**. The LINE conductors **14** and the NEUTRAL conductor **16** are connected to the SEHM **100** structured to monitor powerline event and health based at least in part on changes in line voltages and frequencies and/or status of the SPD **130**.

[0021] FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram of a smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) **100** in accordance with the disclosed concept. The SEHM **100** is structured to be installed in the power distribution system **30a-n** and electrically connected between LINE conductors **14** and NEUTRAL conductor **16** or ground conductor (not shown). It includes a power supply **110**, a voltage measurement device **120**, a surge protection device (SPD) **130**, a controller **140**, a communication module, a network status indicator **160** and a reset button **170**. The power supply **110** is electrically connected to the conductors **14,16** and supplies low DC power to the electrical components of the SEHM **100**. A voltage measurement device **120** is electrically connected to the LINE conductors **14** and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies and transmit the measured changes to the controller **140**. It may be any type of a voltage sensor suitable for measuring the instantaneous changes in line voltages and frequencies.

[0022] The SPD **130** is connected to the LINE conductors **14** and the NEUTRAL conductor **16** and is structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the ground or NEUTRAL conductor **16**. The SPD **130** or a component thereof may be replaceable. The SPD **130** includes surge protectors (e.g., without limitation, metal oxide varistors (MOVs) **131b** coupled to thermal fuse elements **131a** as shown in FIG. 5) and an SPD status indicator **132** connected to the surge

protectors. As shown in FIG. 5, the SPD **130'** may include surge protectors **131** and an SPD indicator **132**. The surge protectors **131** may include a set of MOVs **131b** each coupled to thermal fuse elements **131a** in series at one end. The MOVs **131b** are connected to the NEUTRAL conductor at the other end. The thermal fuse elements **131a** are electrically connected to the LINE conductors **14** at one end and to the SPD status indicator **132** at the other end. The SPD status indicator **132** may be, a plurality of LEDs, LCD or other suitable SPD status indicator and is structured to indicate real time, instantaneous status of the SPD **130**. For example, a plurality of LEDs **132** may be lit to indicate that the SPDs **130**, **130'** connected to corresponding powerlines are active, i.e., in a healthy operating condition. When the LEDs **132** are turned OFF, it indicates that SPD **130**, **130'** connected to the corresponding powerlines are inactive, i.e., a loss of the surge protection. It will be understood that the LED provides a physical indication of the SPD status on site while the user can view the real time SPD status via the energy monitoring application **51** at any time at any place. Optionally, the SPD **130** may include a counterfeit device monitor **133** structured to provide information for the devices permitted to be installed within the SPD **130**. Optionally, the SPD **130** may also include an SPD module identifier **134** structured to provide an SPD ID such that any future replacement of the SPD **130** can be performed accurately and expeditiously. The counterfeit device monitor **133** and/or the SPD module identifier **134** may be provided as labels disposed on an external surface of the SPD **130** and/or viewed in the energy monitoring application **51**.

[0023] The controller **140** may be a processing unit including a processor and a memory. The processor may be, for example and without limitation, a microprocessor, a microcontroller, or some other suitable processing device or circuitry. The memory can be any of one or more of a variety of types of internal and/or external storage media such as, without limitation, RAM, ROM, EPROM(s), EEPROM(s), FLASH, and the like that provide a storage register, i.e., a machine readable medium, for data storage such as in the fashion of an internal storage area of a computer, and can be volatile memory or nonvolatile memory. The memory may store, e.g., without limitation, the data received from the voltage measurement device **120**, the historical data, customer information, device information, an event or activity log, etc. The controller **140** is structured to receive the measured changes in line voltages and frequencies from the voltage measurement device **120** and transmit data including the measured changes to the cloud **40**. The data may also include, e.g., without limitation, device IDs, user information or geolocation information. In some examples, the controller **140** may analyze the measured changes and determine if a powerline event or anomaly has occurred or is about to occur. In some examples, the controller **140** may directly transmit a notification to the mobile user device **50a-n** based at least in part on detected SPD status and/or the powerline event and health analysis performed by itself.

[0024] The communication module **150** may be Wi-Fi or Bluetooth® low energy (BLE) protocol compliant. It is structured to receive and transmit the data between the controller **140** and the cloud **40** or the notification and/or the data between the controller **140** and the mobile user devices **51a-n** via a wireless connection, e.g., without limitation, a Wi-Fi connection. The network status indicator **160** is connected to the controller **140** and structured to indicate the network connection status of the SEHM **100**. That is, the network status indicator **160** indicates connection or disconnection status of the SEHM **100** to the cloud and/or the mobile user device via the wireless connection. While the network status indicator **160** provides a physical indication of the network connection status of the SEHM **100**, the user may view the network connection status via the energy monitoring application **51** and connect or disconnect the wireless connection. The reset button **170** may be any type of switches structured to be actuated to reset the network connection, e.g., without limitation, Wi-Fi connection or to the device factory setting.

[0025] In operation, the voltage measurement device **120** measures changes in line voltages and frequencies and transmits the measured changes to the controller **140**. The controller **140** in turn transmits the data including the measured changes to the power management service cloud **40** via

the communication module **150** in a wired or wireless connection (e.g., without limitation, Internet, Wi-Fi connection). In some examples, the controller **140** also is capable of analyzing the data and transmit a notification to the mobile user device **50a-n** directly. Upon receiving the data, the power management service cloud **40** analyzes the data based at least in part on the historical data, determines that a powerline event has occurred, and transmits a notification to a corresponding mobile user device **50a-n** in response to the determination, the notification including, e.g., without limitation, the data, status of attached surge protection device (SPD) **130**, recommended actions (e.g., without limitation, replacement of the SPD **130** or a component thereof) and the automatic actions taken by the utility provider **10** or the SEHM **100**. Upon receiving the notification, the user may take preventive or remedial actions such as contacting a field technician **44** for inspection and/or repair of the SPD **130** or a component thereof. Further, in an event of a power source failure (e.g., without limitation, a faulty transformer **11**), the utility provider **10** may contact impacted users and request permissions to perform automatic inspection of the common power source **11** and/or affected areas, or conduct maintenance, replacement and/or repair of the faulty transformer. [0026] Accordingly, the SEHM **100** according to the disclosed concept not only provides real time detection of powerline events or anomalies, but also provides capabilities and benefits that are not provided by the conventional surge protection devices. For example, the SEHM **100** continuously monitors and logs voltages, frequencies, surge events and other power line related anomalies, thereby allowing the user to review at any time the current and past data of power line events and overall powerline health that have been logged by the SEHM **100**. By promptly notifying the user of any powerline events or anomalies that are currently occurring or about to occur via the mobile user device **50a-n** (e.g., without limitation, via the energy monitoring application **51**, e-mail or SMS) in a wireless connection, the SEHM **100** allows the user to timely take appropriate actions (e.g., without limitation, ordering a replacement of the SPD **130** or components thereof, contacting a field technician, contacting the certified contractor network **53**, etc.) based on the notification. The notification includes analysis results based on the current and historical powerline data using the processing power of the cloud **40**. This is useful in that the powerline data including the measured changes in line voltages and frequencies can be analyzed with a more powerful processing power of the cloud **40**, rather than being limited to the processing power of the controller **140**. The more powerful processing power of the cloud **40** allows for a more reliable, accurate and efficient analysis and determination of the powerline event and health status in real time. Further, by storing and constantly updating the database **42**, the SEHM **100** allows a field technician to better understand the history of powerline events and assist the field technician to identify a potential issue. Additionally, the SEHM **100** may directly alert the user of any detected powerline events or anomalies and analysis results received from the cloud **40** via the communication module **150** via a wireless connection, thereby ensuring that the user is notified of any detected power line events or anomalies even if the connection between the cloud **40** and the mobile user device **50a-n** has failed or lost. Finally, since the building structures **20a-n** are clustered in the same geographical area using the same power source **11**, each SEHM **100** transmits data including measured line voltages and frequencies, powerline events or anomalies related to the same power source **11**. The cloud **40** can therefore combine the data of all of the SEHMs **100** within the geographical area, analyze the combined data, determine that a powerline event or anomaly associated with the common power source **11** (e.g., a faulty transformer) has occurred or is about to occur based on the analysis, and notify the utility provider **10** to dispatch a field technician **54** to perform inspection of the transformer **11** before a powerline event of a larger magnitude takes place. Such prediction and preemption of a future power source failure in a geographic area has not been provided by the conventional surge protection devices. In fact, such prediction of the future powerline events or anomalies based at least in part SPD status has not been offered by the conventional surge protection devices. Indeed, the conventional surge protection devices do not include voltage measurement devices **120** for monitoring powerline event

and health. Thus, the SEHM **100** provides the capabilities and benefits that are novel and unavailable with the conventional surge protection devices.

[0027] FIG. **6** is a flow chart of a method **600** of smart powerline event and health monitoring in a power distribution system in accordance with a non-limiting, example embodiment of the disclosed concept. The method **600** may be performed by the smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) **100** of FIGS. **1-5** or any components thereof.

[0028] At **610**, an SEHM is provided within a power distribution system, the SEHM including a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; the SPD connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module being communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module being structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud.

[0029] At **620**, the voltage measurement device measures real time changes in line voltages and frequencies and transmit the measured changes to the controller of the SEHM.

[0030] At **630**, the controller receives the measured changes from the voltage measurement device and transmits data including the measured changes to the cloud in a wired or wireless connection.

[0031] At **640**, the cloud receives the data, analyze the data based at least in part on historical data including past powerline events, powerline related anomalies or activity logs, determine that a powerline event or anomaly has occurred or is about to occur based on the analysis, and transmit a notification to a mobile user device via a wireless connection.

[0032] At **650**, the mobile user device receives the notification from the cloud.

[0033] At **660**, the user performs a preventative or remedial action based on the notification.

[0034] FIG. **7** is a flow chart for a method **700** of smart powerline event and health monitoring in a power distribution system included in a geographical area having a common power source in accordance with the disclosed concept. The method **700** may be performed by the smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) **100** of FIGS. **1-5** or any components thereof.

[0035] At **710**, an SEHM is provided within a power distribution system included in a utility system for a geographic area having a common power source, the SEHM including a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; the SPD connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module being communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module being structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud. The data include the measured changes, device IDs, user information or geolocation information of the utility system. The historical data include past powerline events, powerline related anomalies or an activity log.

[0036] At **720**, the voltage measurement device measures real time changes in line voltages and frequencies and transmit the measured changes to the controller of the SEHM.

[0037] At **740**, the cloud receives the data and combines the data with data received from other SEHMs associated with respective other building structures located within the geographical area.

[0038] At **750**, the cloud analyzes the combined data based at least in part on the historical data of all of the SEHMs and determines that a powerline event or anomaly associated with the common power source has occurred or is about to occur based on the analysis.

[0039] At **760**, the cloud transmits a notice to a utility provider in response to the determination via the wireless connection, the notification including the combined data, the analysis and the determination.

[0040] At **770**, the utility provider performs automatic actions based on the notice and transmits information including the automatic actions taken by the utility provider to the cloud.

[0041] At **780**, the cloud transmits a notification to a mobile user device via a wireless connection, the notice including the powerline event or anomaly associated with the common power source, automatic actions taken by the utility provider and/or the SEHMs, and/or a recommended action. The automatic actions taken by the utility may include, e.g., without limitation, dispatching a field technician to inspect the common power source and associated areas, determining power source failure or anomaly, and performing repair or replacement of the common power source or components thereof. The automatic actions taken by the SEHMs may include automatic interruption of current flowing to critical or sensitive loads via corresponding circuit interrupters disposed in the power distribution systems. Upon receiving the notification, the user may perform a preventative or remedial action based on the recommended action.

[0042] While specific embodiments of the invention have been described in detail, it will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that various modifications and alternatives to those details could be developed in light of the overall teachings of the disclosure. Accordingly, the particular arrangements disclosed are meant to be illustrative only and not limiting as to the scope of disclosed concept which is to be given the full breadth of the claims appended and any and all equivalents thereof.

Claims

1. A smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) structured to be disposed in a power distribution system for a building structure located in a utility system, the SEHM comprising: a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; a surge protection device (SPD) connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module being communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module being structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud.
2. The device of claim 1, wherein the SPD includes a plurality of surge protectors and an SPD status indicator connected to the surge protectors, the line conductors and the neutral conductor, the SPD status indicator being structured to indicate SPD status for a corresponding powerline.
3. The device of claim 2, wherein the SPD status indicator comprises a plurality of LEDs each connected to corresponding line conductors and wherein when an LED is lit, the corresponding powerline is healthy and the respective SPD is active, and wherein when the LED is turned OFF, the corresponding powerline is not healthy and the respective SPD is inactive or lost.
4. The device of claim 1, wherein the data include the measured changes, device IDs, user information or geolocation information associated with the building structure.
5. The device of claim 1, wherein the cloud includes or communicatively coupled to a database structured to store the data and historical data including past powerline events, powerline related anomalies or activity logs associated with the SEHM.
6. The device of claim 1, wherein the cloud is structured to receive the data, analyze the data based at least in part on historical data including past powerline events, powerline related anomalies or activity logs, determine that a powerline event or anomaly has occurred or is about to occur, and

transmit a notification to the mobile user device in response to the determination in a wireless connection.

7. The device of claim 6, wherein the notification includes the data, analysis results, a recommended action and automatic actions taken in response to the determination.

8. The device of claim 7, wherein the power distribution system includes a plurality of circuit interrupters structured to interrupt current flowing to respective loads, and wherein the recommended action comprises ordering a replacement SPD or SPD component, interrupting current flowing to critical loads via respective circuit interrupters, contacting a field technician for inspection and/or maintenance of the SPD, or contacting a certified contractor network.

9. The device of claim 7, wherein the automatic actions include automatically interrupting current flowing to critical or sensitive loads via respective circuit interrupters by the SEHM based on the determination.

10. The device of claim 7, wherein the cloud is further structured to combine the data with data received from a plurality of other SEHMs associated with other building structures located in a same geographical area having a common power source, analyze the combined data based at least in part on historical data of all of the SEHMs and determine that a powerline event or anomaly associated with the common power source has occurred or is about to occur based on the analysis.

11. The device of claim 10, wherein the cloud transmits a notice to a utility provider associated with the common power source based on the determination, the notice including the combined analysis results, and wherein the automatic actions include dispatching, by the utility provider, a field technician for inspection and/or repair of the common power source.

12. The device of claim 1, wherein the controller is further structured to directly transmit a notification to a mobile user device including an energy monitoring application, the mobile user device being communicatively coupled to the cloud, the notification including the data, a recommended action and automatic actions taken by the SEHM or the cloud.

13. The device of claim 12, wherein the SPD includes an SPD indicator structured to indicate SPD status and a plurality of metal oxide varistors (MOVs) each connected in series with respective thermal fuse elements connected to the SPD indicator, the line conductors and the neutral conductor, and wherein the controller is further structured to directly transmit the notification to the mobile user device, the notification including the SPD status and a recommended action based at least in part on the SPD status.

14. A utility system, comprising: a power source having powerlines; a plurality of building structures each including respective power distribution systems having a smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) electrically connected to the powerlines and structured to monitor powerline event and health based at least in part on changes in line voltages and frequencies and/or a status of a surge protection device (SPD), the SEHM comprising: a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; the SPD connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module being communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module being structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud; a mobile user device including an energy monitoring application installed therein; and a power management service cloud communicatively coupled to the communication module of the SEHM and the mobile user device, wherein the communication module is structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud.

15. A method of providing smart powerline event and health monitoring in a utility system having a power distribution system associated with respective building structure, the method comprising:

providing a smart powerline event and health monitoring device (SEHM) within a power distribution system, the SEHM including a voltage measurement device connected to line conductors and structured to measure changes in line voltages and frequencies; the SPD connected to the line conductors and the neutral conductor and structured to shunt electrical energy from a voltage surge to the neutral conductor; a controller connected to the voltage measurement device and the SPD and structured to receive the measured changes from the voltage measurement device; and a communication module connected to the controller, the communication module being communicatively coupled to a cloud and a mobile user device having an energy monitoring application installed therein, the communication module being structured to receive the data including the measured changes from the controller and transmit the data to the cloud; measuring, by the voltage measurement device, real time changes in line voltages and frequencies and transmitting the measured changes to the controller; receiving and transmitting, by the controller, data including the measured changes to the cloud; analyzing, by the cloud, the data based at least in part on the historical data; determining, by the cloud, that a powerline event or anomaly has occurred or is about to occur based on the analysis; transmitting, by the cloud, a notification to the mobile user device via a wireless connection; and performing a preventive or remedial action based on the notification.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the utility system includes a plurality of other building structures disposed in a geographical area having a common power source, the method further comprising: combining, by the cloud, the data and data received from other SEHMs associated with the other building structures; analyzing, by the cloud, combined data including measured changes in line voltages and frequencies associated with respective building structures; determining, by the cloud, that a powerline event or anomaly associated with the common power source has occurred or is about to occur based on the analysis; transmitting, by the cloud, to a utility provider, a notice including the determination; and performing, by the utility provider, an automatic action in response to the notice.

17. The method of claim 16, further comprising: transmitting, by the utility provider, to the cloud the automatic action taken by the utility provider; and transmitting, by the cloud, the notification to the mobile user device, the notification including the powerline event or anomaly associated with the common power source, automatic actions taken by the utility provider and/or the SEHM and/or a recommended action.

18. The method of claim 17, further comprising: performing, by the user, a preventative or remedial action based on the notification.

19. The method of claim 15, further comprising: indicating, by the SPD status indicator, SPD status; and/or transmitting, by the controller, the notification including the SPD status to the mobile user device via a wireless connection.

20. The method of claim 19, further comprising: providing a network connection status of the SEHM to the mobile user device, the network connection status including connection or disconnection status of the SEHM to the cloud and/or the mobile user device via the wireless connection.
